Nehru, Indians had established a string of armed outposts along the LAC, and even beyond it.

Maxwell based his arguments on a classified Indian intelligence report that had been leaked to him, known as the Henderson Brooks–Bhagat Report, and written by two senior Indian Army officers, Lieutenant General T.B. Henderson Brooks and Brigadier Premindra Singh Bhagat. The report supposedly backed up Maxwell's claim that the war was India's fault and China did little more than strike back to reassert its territorial claims along the Sino-Indian border. China was the largely innocent victim of Nehru's hostile policies.

Also, according to Maxwell, India had no case when it came to the actual disputed areas. Those had been included in some, but not all, maps produced unilaterally by the British India Government in the 1930s, and, more consistently in those produced in independent India after 1947. Prior to that, the northern borders of British India as shown on the official maps had essentially been identical to those on the Chinese ones, at the foot of the mountains where the Assam plains begin.

The British, Tibetan, and Chinese delegates had met at Shimla, British India's summer capital in the highlands above the northern plains, in 1913 and 1914 to sort out the status of Tibet and its borders. But the conference, it has been argued by Maxwell, Alastair Lamb, and other Western scholars, ended inconclusively, as the Chinese refused to accept the British and Tibetan proposals.

I found Maxwell's book very persuasive. It was well written, rich in details, and meticulously footnoted. Reading more about the issue, I also discovered that Maxwell's book had had a tremendous impact on studies by many Western and Asian scholars as well as policymakers.

Not surprisingly, China's leaders have heaped praise on Maxwell's book. At an official banquet in Beijing in 1971, China's Premier Zhou Enlai and Pakistan's Prime Minister Zulfikar Ali Bhutto, both rose from the head table and walked over to where the foreign correspondents were seated. Maxwell was there, and Zhou offered him a toast. 'Mister Maxwell,' Zhou said through his interpreter, 'your book has done a service to truth and China has benefited from that.'[1]

Even former US Secretary of State Henry Kissinger was impressed, as shown in his book *On China*, in which he refers to India's Forward Policy